TASK 5

CASE STUDY

The Identity Trap – A Realistic Fictional Scenario

Identity Theft is a type of cybercrime where a person's personal information such as Aadhaar number, phone number, OTP, or bank details is stolen and misused for fraudulent activities. Unlike direct hacking, this crime relies on tricking individuals into sharing sensitive information.

➢ The Situation: A Fake Bank Verification Call

Rahul, a college student, received a phone call from someone claiming to be a bank official. The caller informed him that his bank account would be blocked due to incomplete KYC verification.

To solve the issue, the caller asked Rahul to confirm his Aadhaar number and share the OTP sent to his phone. Since the situation sounded urgent and official, Rahul trusted the caller and provided the details without verifying their identity.

• How It Happens

The first step is when the scammer contacts the victim by pretending to be from a trusted organization like a bank or government authority.

Next, they create fear or urgency, such as threatening account suspension. This pressures the victim into acting quickly without thinking.

Then, they ask for sensitive details like OTP, PIN, or personal identification information. The victim, believing the request is genuine, shares this information.

Once the scammer gets access, they use the details to log into the victim's bank account or digital platforms.

• The Final Part of the Trap

After gaining access, the scammer performs unauthorized transactions or links the account to their own devices. Rahul soon receives multiple transaction alerts showing money being deducted from his account.

By the time he realizes something is wrong, the money has already been transferred. Since the scammer used valid credentials, it becomes difficult to reverse the transactions immediately.

➢ Target and Consequences

Identity theft commonly targets students, elderly people, and individuals who are not fully aware of digital security practices.

The consequences include financial loss, misuse of personal identity, and emotional stress. Victims may also face long-term issues such as unauthorized accounts being created in their name or difficulty regaining control over their financial data.

This case highlights the importance of never sharing personal or banking information without proper verification.